GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

Ministry of Coal

Powering Growth with Responsibility

Confidential and Proprietory
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SHRI NARENDRA MODI

HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA



MESSAGE

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SHRI G. KISHAN REDDY



HONORABLE MINISTER,

MINISTRY OF COAL

MESSAGE

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SHRI MUNINDRA KUMAR

DIRECTOR GENERAL, CHAMBER OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRIES OF INDIA



MESSAGE

The coal sector continues to play a strategic role in supporting India's energy security, industrial growth, and economic development. While the nation steadily transitions towards a diversified energy future, coal remains an essential resource for power generation, steel production, cement manufacturing, and numerous industrial applications. The Ministry of Coal is therefore central to ensuring sustainable resource management, operational efficiency, technological modernization, and responsible mining practices.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India) recognizes the importance of promoting innovation, investment, environmental sustainability, digital transformation, and advanced mining technologies within the coal sector. Through policy engagement, industry collaboration, investment facilitation, technology partnerships, startup promotion, and capacity-building initiatives, CCI India seeks to support the Ministry's vision of developing a modern, efficient, and environmentally responsible coal ecosystem.

This Knowledge Paper provides detailed insights into the Ministry's strategic priorities, policy initiatives, sectoral reforms, investment opportunities, sustainability measures, and emerging technological advancements. It explores opportunities in commercial mining, mine digitization, clean coal technologies, mine safety, logistics optimization, environmental restoration, skill development, and responsible resource utilization.

The publication is intended to serve as a valuable reference for policymakers, mining companies, investors, technology providers, academic institutions, research organizations, financial institutions, and development partners committed to strengthening India's mining ecosystem. Through collaborative engagement, it seeks to encourage innovation, improve productivity, attract investment, and promote sustainable industrial development.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

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PREFACE

The **Ministry of Coal** occupies a strategically sensitive position in India's development architecture because it sits at the intersection of **energy security, industrial growth, logistics efficiency, regional development, fiscal revenues, and just transition planning**. Coal continues to remain a foundational input for India's power generation system and several hard-to-abate industries, even as the national policy direction simultaneously advances cleaner energy pathways, energy diversification, and sustainability-linked modernization. This duality makes the Ministry's role more complex than that of a conventional extractive-sector department: it is not only a custodian of mineral production, but also a coordinator of national energy resilience during a period of structural transition.

This knowledge paper has been prepared to support a more strategic dialogue between the **Ministry of Coal** and **CCI India** on collaborative opportunities that can improve implementation efficiency, investment mobilization, stakeholder coordination, innovation adoption, and ecosystem development. The paper is intended for senior decision-makers across government, industry, investors, public institutions, and development partners who require an analytical rather than descriptive understanding of the Ministry's evolving mandate.

CCI India envisions a constructive role as an **industry-government bridge**, **investment facilitation platform**, **knowledge partner**, **innovation enabler**, and **implementation support institution**. In a sector where operational scale is large, reform pathways are cross-sectoral, and stakeholder interests are often fragmented, such a partnership model can help translate policy intent into measurable outcomes.

This paper is designed to provide not only a structured review of the Ministry and the coal sector, but also a forward-looking collaboration blueprint aligned with India's long-term aspiration of **Viksit Bharat 2047**.

Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India)

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About CCI India

CCI India (The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) is a premier national business chamber dedicated to fostering economic growth, industry development, entrepreneurship, innovation, and investment promotion across India. As the voice of Indian business and industry, CCI India serves as a bridge between government, industry, startups, academia, investors, and civil society, facilitating meaningful collaboration for nation-building and sustainable development.

Through policy advocacy, business facilitation, research, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and strategic partnerships, CCI India works to create an enabling environment for enterprises of all sizes. The Chamber actively supports key national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Digital India, Atmanirbhar Bharat, Skill India, and Viksit Bharat 2047 by connecting innovative enterprises with government opportunities and promoting inclusive economic development.

India operates through sector-specific councils, industry forums, knowledge platforms, and state-level engagements that address emerging opportunities and challenges across sectors including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, healthcare, education, infrastructure, sustainability, MSMEs, and startups. The Chamber regularly organizes policy dialogues, investment summits, business delegations, workshops, conferences, and knowledge-sharing initiatives to strengthen India's economic ecosystem.

With a strong commitment to innovation, entrepreneurship, and public-private collaboration, CCI India strives to empower enterprises, facilitate investment, enhance competitiveness, and contribute to India's journey toward becoming a globally competitive and economically resilient nation. Its role as a knowledge partner and industry catalyst enables ministries, departments, state governments, startups, and businesses to collaborate effectively in achieving national development objectives.

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1: INTRODUCTION TO THE MINISTRY

The **Ministry of Coal** is the nodal ministry responsible for the exploration, allocation, production facilitation, policy administration, and overall development of coal resources in India. Its role extends beyond resource management into areas of energy planning, commercial mining reform, public sector coordination, block allocation, sector governance, and increasingly, technology-led modernization and sustainability-linked transformation.

Historically, the Ministry evolved in response to the strategic importance of coal in India's industrial and power economy. Over time, its mandate has shifted from a state-dominant administrative model to a more reform-oriented architecture involving **auction-based allocation**, **private participation**, **commercial mining**, and **digital governance mechanisms**. This evolution reflects a broader policy recognition that coal security is not merely a supply-side issue; it is deeply linked to national productivity, manufacturing competitiveness, electricity reliability, and macroeconomic resilience.

This widened mandate also changes the skill profile the Ministry itself must build internally. Administering auctions, monitoring revenue-sharing compliance, and now screening competitive bids for gasification incentives require commercial, financial, and contract-management capabilities that differ materially from the engineering and geological expertise that historically defined the institution. Recognising and closing this internal capability gap is itself a precondition for the reform agenda to deliver its intended outcomes, and is an area where structured external partnership can meaningfully shorten the learning curve.

From a governance perspective, the Ministry performs a balancing function. On one side, it must ensure adequate domestic resource development to support power generation and industrial demand. On the other, it must manage land, environmental, logistics, social, technological, and investment complexities that influence whether planned output actually translates into usable energy and economic value. This makes the Ministry a pivotal actor in the broader national development system.

Its constitutional and national significance arises from its connection to **public welfare, federal coordination, strategic industries, and infrastructure growth**. Coal-bearing regions often overlap with developmentally sensitive geographies, making the Ministry's policy decisions consequential for livelihoods, regional equity, and social legitimacy. The Ministry is therefore not only a sector regulator and facilitator, but a strategic institution in the governance of India's development transition.

This dual identity also means the Ministry is judged against two different scorecards simultaneously by different audiences: investors and industry assess it on the predictability and speed of its regulatory and auction processes, while local communities and state governments assess it on the tangibility of development outcomes in mining-affected districts. A collaboration model that helps the Ministry perform credibly against both scorecards at once, rather than trading one off against the other, is likely to generate the most durable institutional goodwill.

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